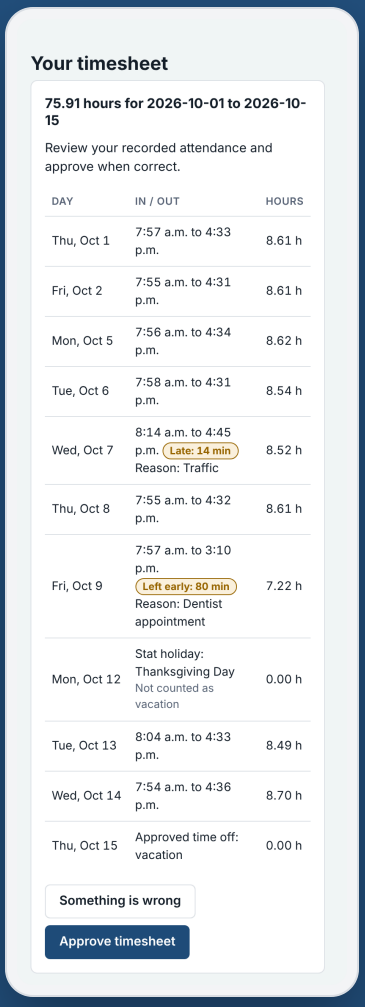
ICUBE DEVELOPMENT (CALGARY) LTD.

Timeclock Employee Guide

How to tap in and out, explain a late start or early departure, approve your timesheet and request vacation.





START HERE

What you will use

You don't need a password or an account. You need your timeclock card and your work email.

ITEM	WHAT IT IS FOR
Your timeclock card	Tap it on the clock when you arrive and when you leave. The card is yours alone. Never tap for anyone else, and don't lend your card.
The clock screen	Confirms every tap. The big word tells you what was recorded.
Your work email	The clock emails you about late starts, early departures, missed punches, your timesheet and vacation. Most emails contain a private link.
Private links	Open your timesheet, your late-arrival or early-departure reason, or your vacation page. Each link belongs to you only and stops working after a set time. Don't forward them.
Your manager	Fixes anything the clock got wrong and records sick days and other time away. Only your manager can change a punch time.

In this guide

1 **Tapping in and out**
What each clock screen means

2 **Emails from the timeclock**
Which messages you can receive and what to do

3 **Late arrivals and early departures**
When a tap is flagged, and adding a reason

4 **Reviewing and approving your timesheet**
Checking your hours at the end of each pay period

5 **Requesting vacation**
Vacation requests and your vacation history

6 **Problems and quick answers**

New in this version

- **Early departures.** Leaving before your scheduled finish is flagged, and you can add a reason (Chapter 3).
- **Grace period.** A tap only counts as late or early when it's outside your clock's grace period, usually 5 minutes.
- **Vacation page.** The time-off form is now for vacation only. Stat holidays inside a request aren't counted as vacation (Chapter 5).

The timeclock records attendance only

It records when you tapped in and out. It doesn't calculate your pay, breaks or overtime. If something about your pay looks wrong, ask your manager.

The screenshots come from the actual timeclock software running on sample data. The names and addresses (Dana Morales, Sam Patel, Jordan Lee, Riley Chen, timeclock.example.com) are made up. Your own screens will show your name, your company's web address and your own hours.

CHAPTER 1

Tapping in and out

When nobody is using the clock, it shows the date, the time and **TAP YOUR CARD**. The bars in the top corner show Wi-Fi signal strength.



Waiting for a card

1. Hold your card flat against the reader until the screen changes.
2. The clock shows **CARD READ / VERIFYING...** and then **SAVED / CONFIRMING...**. Keep your card away from the reader while it does this.
3. Within a few seconds, a big **IN**, **OUT** or **LATE** appears, with your name at the top and the recorded time at the bottom. You'll also hear a short beep pattern.

You don't choose IN or OUT. The clock decides from your previous tap: your first tap starts your shift (IN) and your next tap ends it (OUT).



1. Card read
The clock is checking your card.

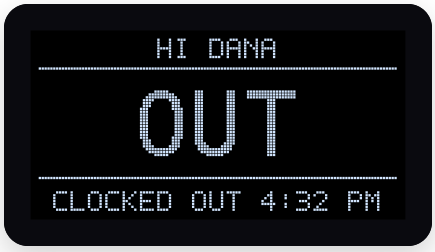


2. Saved
Your tap is stored and being confirmed.

3. The result



IN
Your shift has started. The bottom line shows the recorded time.



OUT
Your shift has ended. Tap out every time you leave. Leaving early also shows OUT; any early departure is checked later (Chapter 3).



LATE
You're clocked in, but later than your scheduled start plus the grace period. You'll get an email where you can add a reason (Chapter 3).

> **Good habits**
> Tap once and wait for the result. Tap out when you leave for lunch or an errand, and tap in again when you're back. If you forget a tap, tell your manager the same day so your timesheet can be corrected.

Other clock messages

Some taps produce a different screen. Here is what each one means and what to do.



ALREADY RECORDED
You tapped again right after a tap that was already counted. Nothing new is recorded. No action needed.



SEE MANAGER / SWIPE SAVED
Your tap was saved, but it needs a manager to look at it. Let your manager know.



VACATION / NO PUNCH NEEDED
Your account is set up to track vacation only, so you don't need to tap in or out. Nothing is recorded.



SCAN BUSY / TAP AGAIN
The clock was busy with another card. Tap your card again.



INVALID CARD / NOT RECORDED
The clock doesn't recognize this card. Nothing was recorded. Tell your manager right away.



CLOCK NOT SYNCED / NOT RECORDED
The clock isn't sure of the correct time, so it refused the tap. Nothing was recorded. Tell your manager.

> **Whenever the screen says NOT RECORDED**
> Your tap did not count. Tell your manager what time you arrived or left so they can add it. The same applies to **SAVE FAILED**.

When the clock is offline

If the clock loses its connection, it keeps working. Your tap is saved on the clock and you'll see **SAVED / CONFIRMING...** instead of IN or OUT. The idle screen then shows how many taps are waiting, for example **3 SAVED ON CLOCK**. When the connection returns, it shows **SENDING 2 SWIPES** while it catches up. Saved taps keep their original time, so you don't need to tap again.



Taps waiting on the clock



Connection back, sending saved taps

CHAPTER 2

Emails from the timeclock

Emails come from your company's timeclock address. Your company decides which ones are turned on, so you might not receive all of them.

EMAIL	WHEN IT COMES	WHAT TO DO
Welcome to the timeclock	When your manager sets you up on the timeclock	Keep it. It contains the web address for requesting vacation.
Late arrival on (date)	When you tap in later than your scheduled start plus the grace period	Optional: add a reason with the link (Chapter 3).
Early departure on (date) NEW	Shortly after your scheduled finish, if your last tap out was earlier than the finish minus the grace period	Optional: add a reason with the link (Chapter 3).
No IN punch / No OUT punch for (date)	A few minutes after your scheduled start or finish, if you haven't tapped	Tell your manager the time you started or left. If you already tapped, or you're still working, ignore it.
Your timesheet for (dates)	At the end of each pay period	Open the link, check your hours and approve (Chapter 4).
Timesheet for (dates)	When your manager sends you a new timesheet link	Use this newest link. Older links for that period stop working.
Your vacation request link	When you ask for one on the Vacation page	Use it within 24 hours (Chapter 5).
Vacation request received / approved / denied / cancelled	When you submit a request, and when your manager decides on it	Read the manager note, if any.
Timesheet approved without your confirmation	When your manager approves your hours for you	Contact your manager if anything is wrong.
Swipe recorded	After each tap, if your company turns it on	Nothing. It confirms the tap.

EXAMPLE EMAIL
To: dana.morales@example.com
Timeclock: Late arrival on 2026-10-07

Hello Dana Morales,

Scheduled start: 2026-10-07 08:00:00
Recorded IN: 2026-10-07 08:14:00
Late: 14 minutes

To add a reason, use this link within seven days:
https://timeclock.example.com/n/523bf1...

Contact your manager about any approved exception.

EXAMPLE EMAIL
To: dana.morales@example.com
Timeclock: Early departure on 2026-10-09

Hello Dana Morales,

Scheduled finish: 2026-10-09 16:30:00
Recorded OUT: 2026-10-09 15:10:00
Early: 80 minutes

To add a reason, use this link within seven days:
https://timeclock.example.com/n/8e04ac...

Contact your manager about any approved exception.

Is this email real? Real timeclock links always start with your company's timeclock web address, like the one in your welcome email. The timeclock never asks for a password. If you're unsure, ask your manager before you click.

CHAPTER 3

Late arrivals and early departures

Your company sets a short **grace period** on each clock, usually 5 minutes. Taps inside the grace period are on time. Beyond it, the minutes count from your scheduled start or finish, rounded up to the next minute.

Late arrival

Your first tap in for a shift is late when it's after your scheduled start plus the grace period. The clock shows **LATE** and emails you right away.

Coming back from lunch or an errand is never late. Only the first tap in for a shift counts.

Early departure

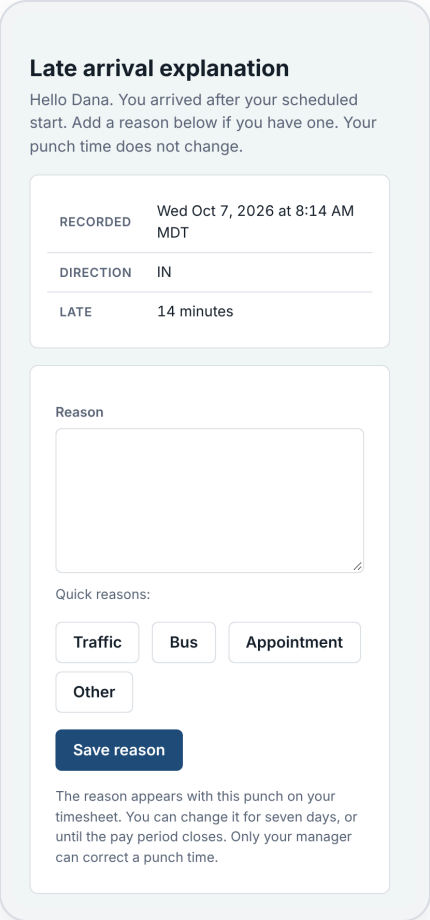
Your last tap out is early when it's before your scheduled finish minus the grace period. The clock still shows **OUT**. The check happens shortly after your scheduled finish plus the grace period, so a tap out for lunch or an errand isn't flagged if you tap back in before then.

START 8:00, GRACE 5 MIN	
8:05:00	On time
8:05:01	Late: 6 minutes
8:14:00	Late: 14 minutes

FINISH 4:30 P.M., GRACE 5 MIN	
4:25:00 p.m.	On time
4:24:59 p.m.	Early: 6 minutes
3:10:00 p.m.	Early: 80 minutes

For an overnight shift, the finish is the next morning.

> **What isn't flagged**
>
> Approved full-day vacation, and absences your manager has recorded as excused, aren't flagged as late or early. Without a schedule for that day, nothing is flagged.



The late arrival page

Adding a reason

The **Late arrival** and **Early departure** emails contain a private link. Use it to tell your manager why. Adding a reason is optional.

1. Open the link in the email.
2. Check the details: when you tapped, the direction (IN or OUT) and how many minutes late or early.
3. Type a reason, or tap a quick reason: **Traffic**, **Bus** or **Appointment**. **Other** just moves the cursor into the box so you can type.
4. Tap **Save reason**.

Your reason can be up to 500 characters.

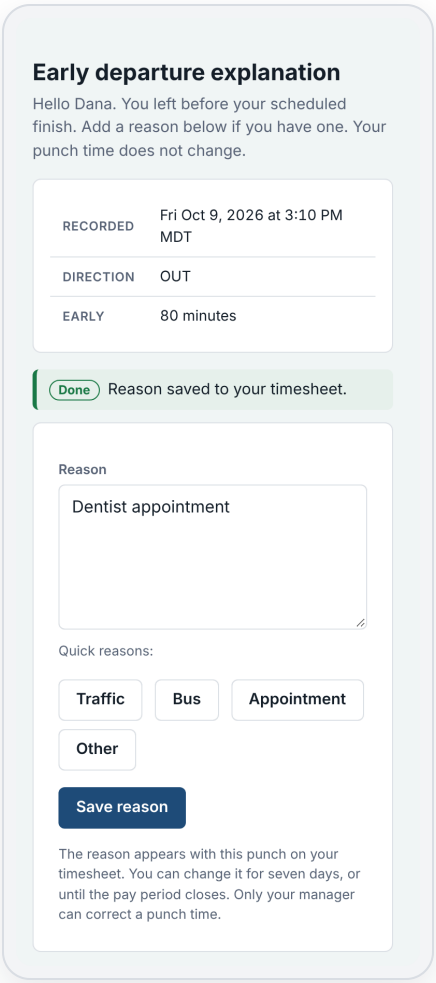
> **A reason doesn't change your punch time**
>
> The tap stays at the time it was recorded. Only your manager can correct a punch time. If the clock got the time wrong, contact your manager.

After you save

The page shows Done **Reason saved to your timesheet.** The reason now appears next to that punch on your timesheet.

You can change the reason using the same link for **seven days**, or until the pay period closes, whichever comes first. After that, the page only shows the saved reason and says **This link is closed.** Contact your manager if it needs to change.

Your manager can also add a note to a late or early punch. It shows on your timesheet the same way.



An early departure reason, saved

CHAPTER 4

Reviewing and approving your timesheet

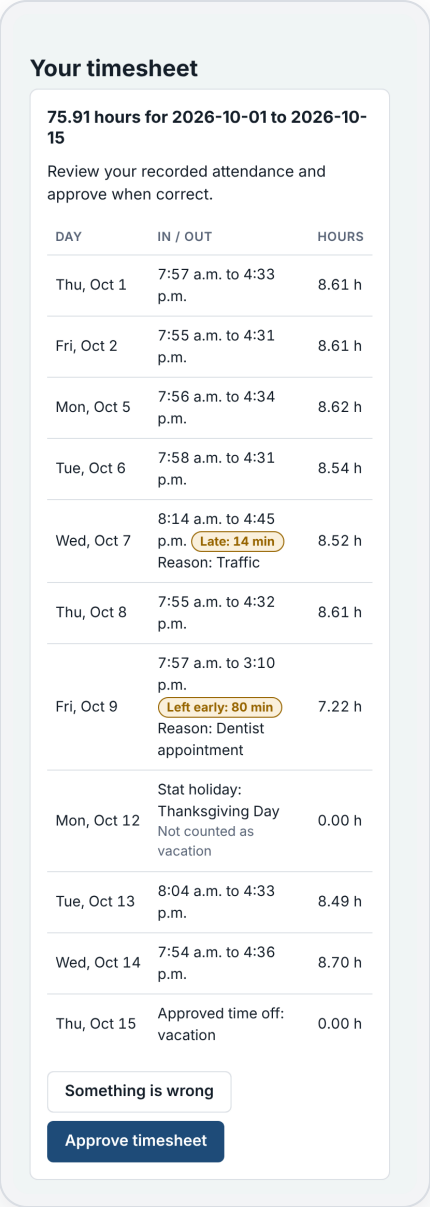
At the end of each pay period, you'll get an email with a private link to your timesheet. The link works for **14 days**.

What the page shows

- **Top line:** your total recorded hours for the pay period.
- **One row per shift:** the day, your IN and OUT times, and the hours between them. A shift that ends after midnight is marked **(next day)**.
- **Flags** on a row: Late: 14 min, Left early: 80 min, Manager correction, Manager-added punch, or Missing punch.
- **Reason:** any late-arrival or early-departure reason you or your manager added.
- **Shaded rows** for stat holidays and approved vacation. These show 0.00 h because no punches are recorded on those days. Stat holidays say **Not counted as vacation**.

Hours are the time between your IN and OUT taps. The timeclock doesn't deduct breaks or calculate pay.

> **If you're set up for vacation only**
>
> Your page lists your vacation days and stat holidays and says **Vacation record only. No timesheet approval required.** There is no Approve button. If you tap the clock during the period, approval is required as usual.



A complete timesheet, ready to approve

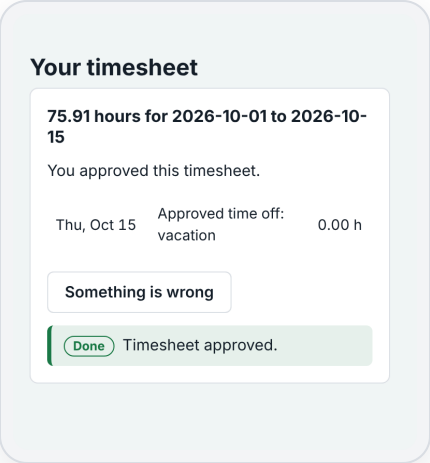
Approving

1. Check every row against what you actually worked.
2. If everything is right, tap **Approve timesheet**.
3. Your browser asks: *"Approve this recorded timesheet? Your manager can still correct errors."* Choose **OK**.
4. The page shows Done **Timesheet approved.** and the top of the page now says **You approved this timesheet.**

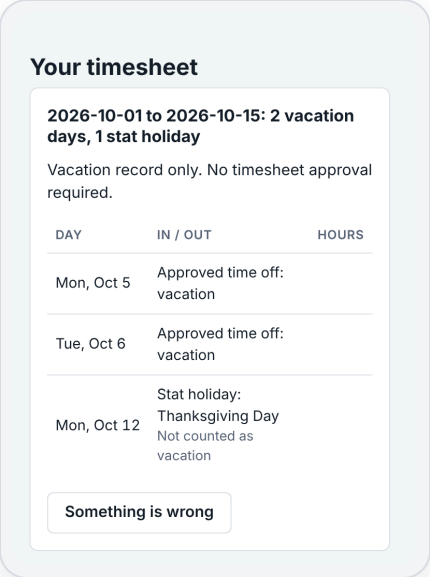
When you can approve

- **Approval opens on the last day of this period.** If you open the link earlier, you can look but the Approve button is hidden.
- **This period is closed.** Once the pay period is closed, you can view the page but not approve it.
- If your manager changes your hours or vacation after you approve, the Approve button comes back. Check the changes and approve again.

> **Approving confirms what was recorded**
> Your manager can still correct errors after you approve. Your manager can also approve your hours without you. If that happens, you'll get an email saying so.



After approving (middle rows hidden)



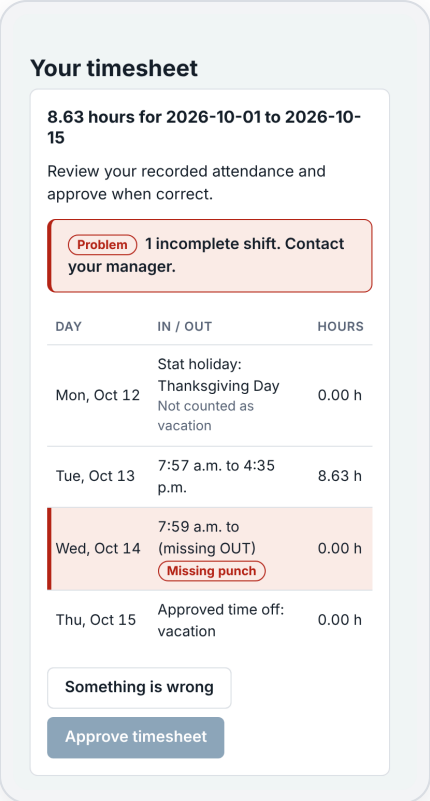
Vacation only: no approval needed

When something is wrong

Missing punches

If a shift is missing its IN or OUT, the row turns red with a Missing punch flag and a banner says, for example, **1 incomplete shift. Contact your manager.**

The **Approve timesheet** button stays greyed out until your manager adds the missing punch. After that, open the same link again and approve.

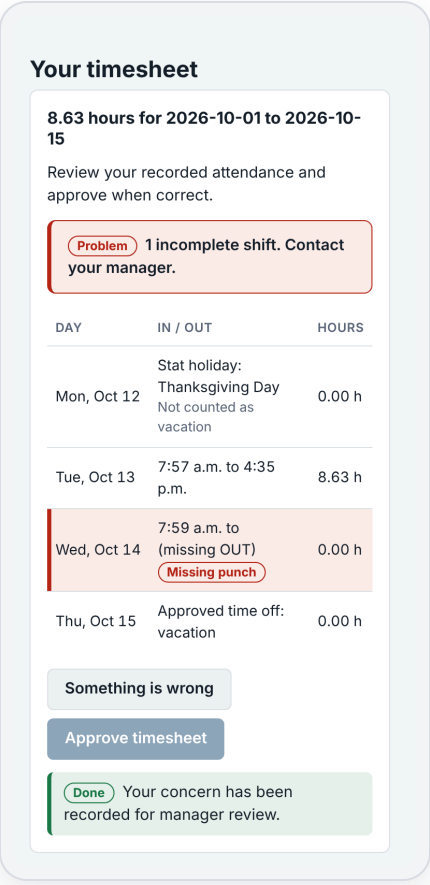


A forgotten OUT tap blocks approval

Reporting a problem

1. Tap **Something is wrong**.
2. Your browser asks: *"What looks wrong with your hours?"* Describe the problem in at least 5 characters. Include the date and the correct time, for example: *I left at 4:30 on Oct 14 but forgot to tap out.*
3. Choose **OK**. The page shows **Your concern has been recorded for manager review.**

Your note is emailed to your managers. You'll see the result on your timesheet once they've made the correction.



Problem reported

CHAPTER 5

Requesting vacation

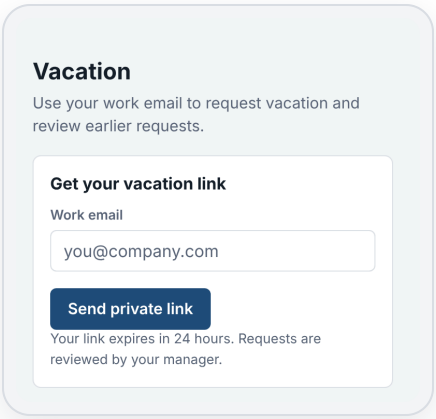
Vacation requests use the **Vacation** page. Its address is in your welcome email and ends in **/time-off**, for example *https://timeclock.example.com/time-off*.

> **This page is for vacation only**
> For a sick day, an appointment or other time away, tell your manager. They record it for you.

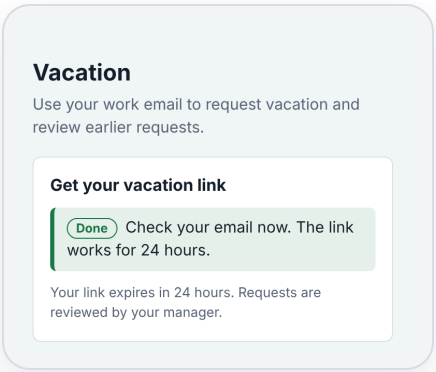
Get your private link

1. Open the Vacation page.
2. Enter your **work email** and tap **Send private link**.
3. The page says **Check your email now. The link works for 24 hours.**
4. Open the email **Your vacation request link** and tap the link.

> **No email arrived?**
> Check that you used the work email your manager has on file, and check your junk folder. If you ask again within 15 minutes, no new email is sent, so use the one you already got. If nothing arrives, ask your manager. They can also send you a link.



Enter your work email



Link sent

Your vacation page

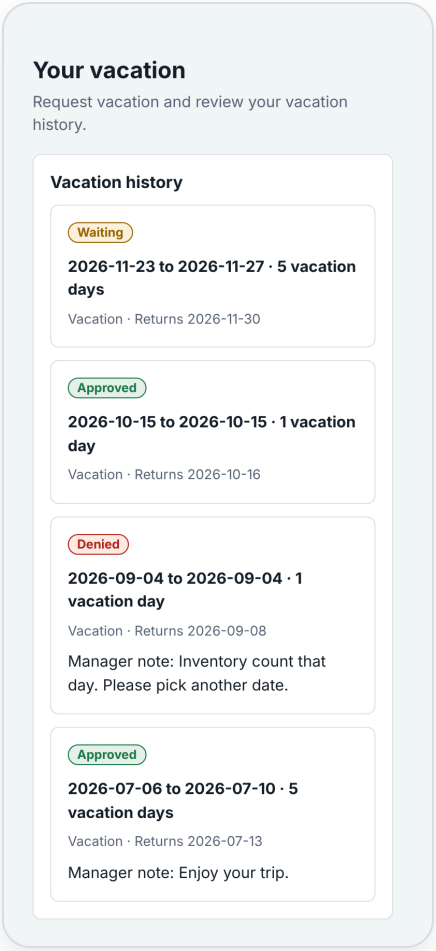
Your private page has two parts: **Vacation history** and **Request vacation**.

Request status

Waiting	Your manager hasn't decided yet.
Approved	The vacation is booked. It appears on your timesheet.
Denied	Not approved. Read the manager note for the reason.
Cancelled	An approval your manager later cancelled.

Each request shows its dates, the number of vacation days, your return date and any manager note. If the dates include a stat holiday, it's listed separately, for example **8 vacation days + 2 stat holidays**.

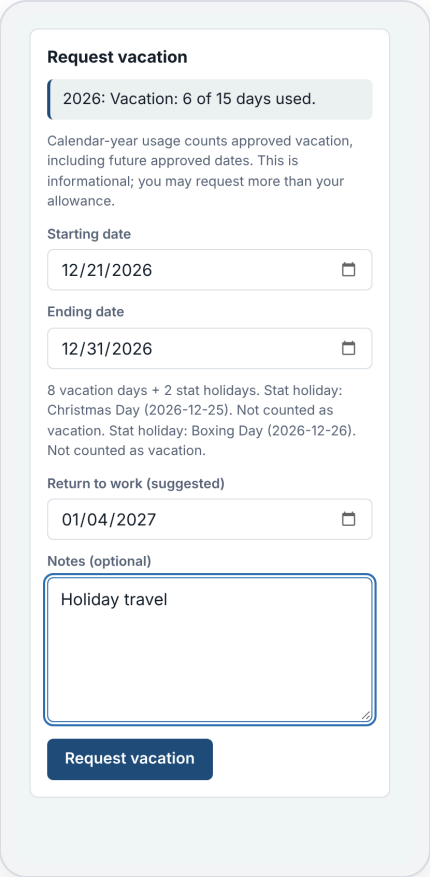
To change or cancel a request, contact your manager. You can't edit a request after you submit it.



Vacation history

Making a new request

1. Pick the **Starting date**. The **Ending date** fills in with the same date for a one-day request. Change it for a longer one. Both dates are included.
2. The page shows the working days, for example **8 vacation days + 2 stat holidays**, and names each holiday. Working days follow your schedule. Stat holidays are not counted as vacation. If you don't have a fixed schedule, it counts weekdays as an estimate.
3. Check **Return to work (suggested)** and change it if needed.
4. Add **Notes** for your manager if you want (up to 500 characters). For a half day, explain it here.
5. Tap **Request vacation**.



A completed request

Your vacation allowance

The grey box shows your approved vacation for the calendar year, for example **2026: Vacation: 6 of 15 days used.** It counts approved vacation days, including future ones. Waiting, denied and cancelled requests aren't counted, and neither are stat holidays.

It's for your information only. You can still request more days than your allowance, and your manager decides. If your request crosses New Year, each year is shown separately. If no allowance is set for you, it says **unspecified**.

CHAPTER 5, CONTINUED

After you submit

The page shows Done **Vacation request submitted. Your manager will review it.** Your new request appears at the top of your vacation history as Waiting.

You'll get a confirmation email, and another email when your manager approves or denies the request. If an approval is later cancelled, you'll be told by email too.

EXAMPLE EMAIL

To: dana.morales@example.com

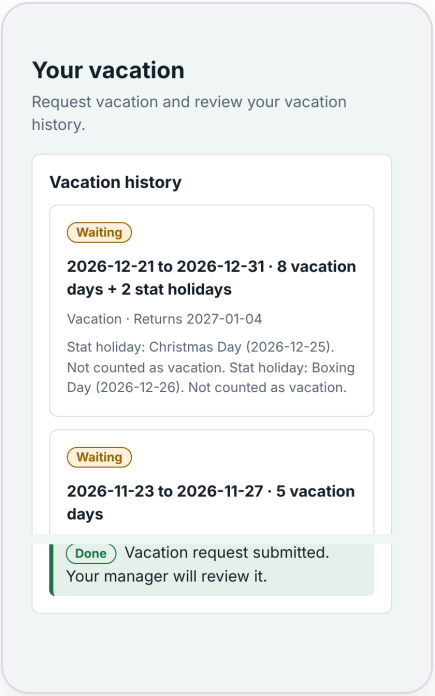
Vacation request received: 2026-12-21 to 2026-12-31

Hello Dana Morales,

Your vacation request for 2026-12-21 to 2026-12-31 (8 working days, returning 2027-01-04) was sent to your manager.

Status: Pending.

The private link stops working 24 hours after it was sent. To come back later, request a new link from the Vacation page.



The new request is waiting

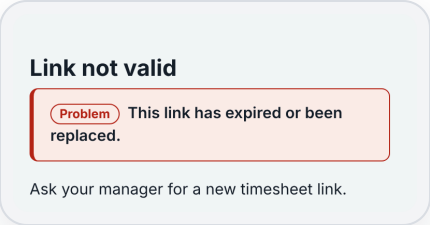
CHAPTER 6

Problems and quick answers

"Link not valid" or "Link expired"

Private links stop working after a set time, or when a newer link replaces them:

Timesheet link	14 days. Ask your manager for a new one.
Late or early reason	7 days, or until the pay period closes.
Vacation link	24 hours. Request a new one from the Vacation page.



An expired timesheet link

SITUATION	WHAT TO DO
I forgot to tap in or out	Tell your manager the actual time, the same day if you can. Don't tap later to make up for it, because the clock records the time you tap.
I tapped twice by mistake	If the screen said ALREADY RECORDED, nothing extra was saved. Otherwise, tell your manager.
The screen said NOT RECORDED	Your tap didn't count. Tell your manager the time.
I got an Early departure email, but I came back	A tap out isn't flagged when you tap back in before your scheduled finish. If you came back but forgot to tap in, tell your manager your return time.
My lateness or early departure was approved	Add the reason with the link in the email. Your manager can also add a note.
My card is lost or damaged	Tell your manager. They'll switch off the old card and give you a replacement. Your past punches are kept.
My timesheet hours look wrong	Use **Something is wrong** on the timesheet page, or contact your manager.
I can't approve my timesheet	Approval opens on the last day of the period and closes when the period is closed. Missing punches also block approval until your manager fixes them.
I need a sick day or other time away	Tell your manager. The Vacation page is for vacation only.
I want to cancel a vacation request	Contact your manager.
Someone asks to use my card, or to tap for them	Say no. Each card records only its owner's attendance.

> **Keep your links private**
>
> Anyone with one of your links can see or act on that page, so don't forward timesheet, vacation, late-arrival or early-departure emails. Each link only works for its time limit.